Language Usage practice booklet: Grade 3 expectations

Grade 3 · Practice booklet

Name: _____

What this booklet is

This is general practice written for Language Usage at Grade 3 level, following the Common Core State Standards for English Language Arts standards for that grade. It is not made from your child's MAP questions, and it does not replace the classroom. Use it as a guide to what a child is expected to know and do at this level.

How to use it

- Do one section at a time, about 10 minutes, 3 days a week. Stop while it is still enjoyable.
- Read each question all the way through, twice, before answering. Underline the key words and say what is being asked.
- Take your time. A careful, correct answer is worth more than a fast one.
- Use scrap paper and show the working. Then check the answer before moving on.
- Ask your child to explain how they got an answer, even when it is right.
- If a section feels too hard, do the section before it again, or ask the teacher. That is part of learning, not a problem.

Section 1: Capital letters, punctuation and spelling

Standards practised: L.3.2, L.3.2a, L.3.2b, L.3.2c, L.3.2d, L.3.2e, L.3.2f, L.3.2g

A worked example

Correct this sentence: maryam said "i bought dates at the souq in sharjah"

1. Start the sentence with a capital letter: Maryam.
2. Names of people and places start with a capital: Maryam, Sharjah. The word I is always a capital.
3. Put a comma after said, then the speaker's exact words go inside quotation marks, with the full stop inside the closing marks.

Maryam said, "I bought dates at the souq in Sharjah."

Questions

1. Rewrite with correct capital letters: the souq in dubai opens at nine o'clock.

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2. Which title is written correctly?

   A. The Falcon And The Desert
   B. The Falcon and the Desert
   C. the falcon and the desert
   D. The Falcon and The Desert

3. Which sentence has the comma in the right place?

   A. Noura lives, in Sharjah United Arab Emirates.
   B. Noura lives in, Sharjah United Arab Emirates.
   C. Noura lives in Sharjah United Arab, Emirates.
   D. Noura lives in Sharjah, United Arab Emirates.

4. Add the missing punctuation: Hamdan said I love date cookies

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5. Which is correct? The ___ hump was full of fat. (There is one camel.)
   A. camel's
   B. camels
   C. camels'
   D. camels's

6. Write the missing apostrophe: the two girls bags were by the door. (There are two girls.)

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7. Write each pair of words as one word with an apostrophe: did not, she is, we will.

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8. Which spelling is correct?
   A. beleive
   B. belive
   C. believe
   D. beleave

9. Add the ending to the base word and write the new word: happy + ness, swim + ing.

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10. Here are guide words at the top of a dictionary page: camel and canal. Which word would you find on that page?
    A. camp
    B. came
    C. cap
    D. cave

11. Explain why Abu Dhabi and Friday begin with capital letters but city and day do not.

Section 2: Grammar and word usage

Standards practised: L.3.1, L.3.1a, L.3.1b, L.3.1c, L.3.1d, L.3.1e, L.3.1f, L.3.1g, L.3.1h, L.3.1i, L.3.3, L.3.3a, L.3.3b, L.3.4, L.3.4a, L.3.4b, L.3.4c, L.3.4d, L.3.5, L.3.5a, L.3.5c, L.3.6

A worked example

Choose the right word: Yesterday Salem (runned / ran) to the metro station.

1. Yesterday tells us the action is in the past, so we need a past tense verb.
2. Run is an irregular verb: it does not add ed.
3. The past tense of run is ran.

ran (Yesterday Salem ran to the metro station.)

Questions

1. In the sentence "The tall falcon flew over the creek", name one adjective and one verb.

   _____

2. Write the plural of each noun: child, fox, baby.

   _____

3. Which is an abstract noun (a thing you cannot touch)?

   A. oryx
   B. creek
   C. souq
   D. kindness

4. Choose the right word: Maryam ___ a bag of dates yesterday.

   A. buyed
   B. bought
   C. buy
   D. buying

5. Rewrite in the future tense: Khalid walks to the metro station.

   _____

6. Choose the right word: The girl and her sister ___ at the mall.

   A. are

   B. is

   C. was

   D. be

7. Choose the right word: Of the three towers, the blue one is the ___.

   A. taller

   B. more tall

   C. tallest

   D. most tall

8. Which word is the adverb in this sentence? Noura carefully poured the karak.

   A. Noura

   B. poured

   C. karak

   D. carefully

9. Choose the best joining word: We stayed inside ___ the sandstorm was strong.

   A. although

   B. but

   C. because

   D. so

10. Choose the best joining word: Hind wanted to swim, ___ the pool was closed.

    A. and

    B. but

    C. or

    D. because

11. Is this a complete sentence? "Because the bus was late." Say yes or no and explain, then fix it if needed.

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12. Join the two sentences into one sentence with the word although: Layla was tired. She finished her homework.

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13. Salem is writing a school report. (a) Which sentence suits written work better? A) The oryx is, like, super big and stuff. B) The Arabian oryx is a large animal with long straight horns. (b) Which sentence gives a stronger picture? A) The wind was loud. B) The wind howled across the dunes.

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14. Read: The desert was scorching, so Layla wore a hat and drank cool water. (a) What does scorching mean? A) very hot B) very windy C) very cold. (b) In the word unlock, which part is the prefix, what does it add to the meaning, and what is the root word? (c) Which book would you use to check how a word is spelled and what it means?

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15. (a) Noura was over the moon about her prize. Does this mean she was on the moon? Say what it really means. (b) Put these words in order from the least hot to the most hot: scorching, warm, hot.

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16. (a) Some birds come to the creek in winter and fly away when it gets warm. Which word means to move to a different place for a season? A) migrate B) hatch C) bury. (b) Choose the word that tells when: Omar ate breakfast. (Later / Beside), he took the metro to school.

Section 3: Writing

Standards practised: W.3.1, W.3.1a, W.3.1b, W.3.1c, W.3.1d, W.2, W.2a, W.3.3, W.3.3a, W.3.3c, W.3.4, W.3.5, W.3.6, W.3.7, W.3.8, W.3.10, SL.3.1, SL.3.2, SL.3.3, SL.3.4, SL.3.5, SL.3.6

A worked example

Put these sentences in the best order to make a short story: (A) At last he waved to the fishermen. (B) Then a wooden dhow sailed into view. (C) Khalid went to the creek at sunrise.

1. A story needs a beginning, a middle and an end.
2. The beginning sets the scene: C, Khalid went to the creek.
3. The middle is what happens next (look for the word Then): B.
4. The end brings the story to a close (look for At last): A.

C, B, A

Questions

1. Write a first sentence that states your opinion on this topic: Should children walk to school when they can?

   _____

2. Give two reasons that support this opinion: Our school should have a daily reading time.

   _____

3. Which word best joins the sentences? Mangroves are important ___ they protect the coast.

   A. because

   B. but

   C. or

   D. although

4. Put these sentences in order: (A) Finally, the clean water is sent to homes. (B) First, seawater is taken into a desalination plant. (C) Next, the salt is removed. Which order is correct?

   A. B, A, C

   B. A, B, C

   C. B, C, A

   D. C, B, A

5. Plan a short story about Maryam, who gets lost in the souq. Write a beginning, a middle and an end in note form.

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6. You are writing about the Arabian oryx. Sort these facts into two groups: long straight horns, eats grass, white coat, lives in the desert.

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7. Make this sentence more exciting by adding detail: The dhow was nice.

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8. Hamdan's falcon is brown. It hunts in the morning. My bike is red. It rests on a perch at night. Which sentence does not belong in a piece about the falcon?

   A. Hamdan's falcon is brown.

   B. It hunts in the morning.

   C. It rests on a perch at night.

   D. My bike is red.

9. Add a sentence of your own to the start of a story that tells where and when it happens, for a character named Salem.

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10. Write a closing sentence for a piece that says parks are good for families.

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11. Name three things to check when you proofread your own writing.

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12. Speaking and listening. Parent: read this aloud slowly, twice if needed: The Arabian oryx has a white coat that keeps it cool, and long straight horns. It lives in the desert and eats grass and leaves. Then say: (1) Tell me the main idea in your own words, and one detail. (2) Now ask me one question about the oryx. Answer it, and let your child listen.

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13. Speaking and listening, with a grown-up. Parent: choose a topic such as dates, falcons or the metro. Say: (1) Let us talk about it together for a minute, taking turns. (2) Now give me a short talk of four or five sentences: say what it is, then tell some facts, then end with a last sentence. Speak clearly in complete sentences.

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14. Speaking and listening, with a grown-up. Parent: let your child draw a simple picture of a dhow at the creek, or use a photograph. Say: (1) Describe your picture to me in at least four complete sentences. (2) Now read me a short story or poem you like, with expression. Optional, with an adult only: you may record the reading on a phone or tablet and play it back together.

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15. Research and notes, with a grown-up. Parent: read this aloud slowly, twice if needed: Date palms grow well in the desert. Their roots reach deep to find water. The sweet fruit, called dates, gives people energy. Palm leaves are used to make baskets and mats. Then say: (1) Write or say brief notes in a few words, not full sentences. (2) Sort them into two groups: the tree, and how people use it. (3) Then find one more fact in a book and add it to a group. Optional: a grown-up may look at a website with you for this fact.

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16. Writing for different readers, with a grown-up. Write two short notes about the same thing, a trip to the museum: one to a friend, Hamdan, and one to your teacher. (2) Say how the two notes are different. (3) Optional, with a grown-up beside you: type one of the notes on a keyboard, then check and fix it together.

Answer guide for parents

Section 1: Capital letters, punctuation and spelling

1. The souq in Dubai opens at nine o'clock. (A sentence starts with a capital and the name of a city has a capital.) Ask: which words in the sentence need a capital letter, and why?
2. B. The Falcon and the Desert. In a title the first word and the main words have capitals, but small words such as and and the do not, unless they come first. If your child chose A, they gave every word a capital. If your child chose D, they gave the second the a capital.
3. D. Noura lives in Sharjah, United Arab Emirates. A comma separates the city from the country: Sharjah, United Arab Emirates. If your child chose A, they put the comma after lives, which splits the sentence too early. If your child chose C, they split the country name in two.
4. Hamdan said, "I love date cookies." (A comma after said, quotation marks round his words, and a full stop inside the marks.) Ask: which words did he say, and how do the quotation marks show that?
5. A. camel's. One camel owns the hump, so the apostrophe goes before the s. If your child chose B, they left out the apostrophe. If your child chose C, they put it after the s, which is for more than one camel.
6. The two girls' bags were by the door. (More than one owner with a plural ending in s, so the apostrophe goes after the s.) Ask: how many girls are there, and where does that tell us to put the apostrophe?
7. didn't, she's, we'll. The apostrophe takes the place of the missing letters: the o in not, the i in is, and wi in will. Ask: which letters did each apostrophe replace?
8. C. believe. The letters ie go in that order, with an e at the end. If your child chose A (beleive), they swapped the i and the e. If your child chose D (beleave), they spelled the sound ee with ea.
9. happiness and swimming. A word that ends in y changes the y to i before ness. A short word like swim doubles the last letter before ing. Ask: why does swimming need two m letters?
10. A. camp. In alphabetical order camp comes after camel and before canal. If your child chose B (came), that word comes before camel. If your child chose C (cap), that word comes after canal.
11. Abu Dhabi and Friday are the special names of one particular place and one particular day (proper nouns), so they take a capital letter. City and day are general words for any city or any day. Ask: can you think of another special name and a general word to match it?

Section 2: Grammar and word usage

1. Adjective: tall. Verb: flew. Ask: which word tells us what the falcon is like, and which tells what it did?
2. children, foxes, babies. Child changes its shape, fox adds es because it ends in x, and baby changes y to ies. Ask: which of these three do not just add an s?
3. D. kindness. You cannot touch kindness because it is an idea or a feeling. If your child chose A, B or C, those are things you can see and touch.
4. B. bought. Buy is an irregular verb, and yesterday needs the past tense. If your child chose A (buyed), they added ed to an irregular verb. If your child chose C (buy), they used the present tense.

5. Khalid will walk to the metro station. Add will before the verb to talk about later. Ask: which small word shows it has not happened yet?
6. A. are. Two people, the girl and her sister, need a plural verb. If your child chose B (is), that verb is for one person. If your child chose C (was), that verb is for one person in the past.
7. C. tallest. Comparing three or more things uses the ending est. If your child chose A (taller), that form is for comparing two things. If your child chose B (more tall), they used more where the ending is needed.
8. D. carefully. It tells how Noura poured. If your child chose B (poured), that is the verb, the action word. If your child chose A (Noura), that is the noun, the person.
9. C. because. The storm is the reason they stayed inside, and because gives a reason. If your child chose A (although) or B (but), they used words for ideas that go against each other.
10. B. but. The two ideas go against each other: Hind wanted to swim, yet the pool was closed. If your child chose A (and), that joins ideas that agree. If your child chose D (because), that gives a reason, but the closed pool is not why she wanted to swim.
11. No, it is a fragment: it does not say what happened because of the late bus. Fix: Omar was late because the bus was late. Ask: what question does the first part leave you wondering about?
12. Although Layla was tired, she finished her homework. (Or: Layla finished her homework although she was tired. Although shows the two ideas go against each other.) Ask: which of the two ideas goes against the other?
13. (a) B. Written work uses full, careful sentences, while A sounds like everyday speech with a friend. (b) B. The word howled and the place across the dunes help the reader hear and see it. Ask: how would you say this to a friend, and how is that different from writing it?
14. (a) A, very hot (the hat and the cool water are clues). (b) The prefix is un-, and it means not or the opposite, so unlock means to open the lock. The root word is lock. (c) A dictionary. Ask: which words in the sentence gave you a clue to the meaning?
15. (a) No. It is a nonliteral phrase meaning she was extremely happy. (b) warm, hot, scorching. Ask: if someone said it was raining cats and dogs, would you look for cats?
16. (a) A, migrate. (b) Later (it shows the order in time; beside tells where, not when). Ask: what other words do you know that mean the same as migrate?

Section 3: Writing

1. A good answer states one clear opinion about the topic in a full sentence. Model: I think children should walk to school when they can. Ask: can you give me one reason for your opinion?
2. A good answer gives two different reasons, each in its own sentence. Model: Reading helps us learn new words. It is also calm and fun. Ask: does each reason say something different from the other?
3. A. because. The second part gives the reason mangroves matter. If your child chose B (but), that joins ideas that disagree. If your child chose D (although), that also joins ideas that go against each other.
4. C. B, C, A. First, Next and Finally show the order. If your child chose A (B, A, C), they put Finally in the middle. If your child chose B (A, B, C), they started with Finally.
5. A good answer has three parts with a character, a setting and a problem. Model: Beginning: Maryam looks at the spices and loses her aunt. Middle: She asks a shopkeeper for help.

End: Her aunt finds her and they drink karak. Ask: what problem does Maryam face, and how does it get solved?

6. Group 1, how it looks: long straight horns, white coat. Group 2, food and home: eats grass, lives in the desert. Ask: what name could you give each group?
7. A good answer adds describing words and details that show the picture. Model: The old wooden dhow rocked gently on the shining blue water. Ask: what can you see, hear or feel on the dhow?
8. D. My bike is red. The other sentences are all about the falcon, but the bike is a different topic. If your child chose A, B or C, ask them whether that sentence tells about the falcon.
9. A good answer names the place and the time and introduces Salem. Model: One quiet morning, Salem walked along the beach in Fujairah. Ask: which words tell the reader where and when?
10. A good answer returns to the opinion and ends the piece. Model: That is why every neighbourhood should have a park. Ask: does your last sentence go back to the opinion?
11. Any three of: capital letters at the start of sentences and names, a full stop or other end mark, correct spelling, apostrophes and commas, and that each sentence makes sense. Ask: can you read it aloud and listen for mistakes?
12. A good answer gives the main idea, for example: the oryx is an animal that is well suited to the desert, with one detail such as the white coat or the horns. The question is about the topic (for example: How much water does it drink?) and the child waits and listens to the answer before speaking again. Ask: what was the main idea, and which detail went with it?
13. Listen for: taking turns and staying on the topic, a clear start, at least two true facts in a sensible order, a closing sentence, speaking clearly at a steady pace in complete sentences (for example: Falcons are birds of prey. They have sharp eyes.), not single words or fragments. Ask: did your talk have a start, some facts and a last sentence?
14. Listen for: complete sentences with a subject and a verb (for example: A wooden dhow floats on the water), describing words and details that match the picture, speaking clearly. In the reading the child reads smoothly, not too fast, with expression (and, if recorded, enjoys listening back). The picture adds to the message. Ask: which sentence tells the most about your picture?
15. Group 1, the tree: grows in the desert, deep roots find water. Group 2, how people use it: dates give energy, leaves make baskets and mats. Notes are short words and phrases, each in the right group, and the extra fact is true, matches its group and says where it came from (the book, or the website if one was used). Ask: which notes belong in which group, and how do you know?
16. A good answer has two clear notes with a greeting and a sign-off. The note to the friend is friendly and relaxed (Hi Hamdan, I can't wait for the museum trip!). The note to the teacher is polite and careful (Dear Miss Hind, May I bring a water bottle on the museum trip?). The child can say that the words and tone change with the reader. A typed note is neat, with capitals and full stops checked. Ask: which note would you change if your teacher were reading it, and how?